

1.1 Guided Notes

What is Design?

FDD UNIT 1 · DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS

NAME _____

DATE _____

“Design is not just what it looks like and feels like. Design is how it works.” —Steve Jobs

1. Graphic design surrounds us: it is the _____ we read, the _____ we buy, and the _____ we inhabit. Design is a _____ art form — we're exposed to thousands of examples of it every single day.
2. Design is not decoration, it is _____. Having design software doesn't automatically make someone good at design.
3. List at least 4 careers in graphic design from the list your teacher shares:

4. One of the hardest things for new designers to accept: design is rarely **representational** (a realistic depiction of a real object) — it's usually **abstract** (an idea without a concrete, literal form). An abstract image can be read as more than one thing at once — that's called **ambiguity**, and it's a *feature*, not a mistake.

Discuss: Where and how do we encounter images in our world? What is graphic design?